

iation recorded in the apparatus was dismaying.” The great Codex Vaticanus differed from its archetypal form no less than thirty-four times, in one chapter. Come now, can a MS that differs from its archetype 34 times in one chapter be called a good copy? What objective basis could anyone have for so doing? By way of comparison, or contrast, I invite attention to the following evidence from Family 35, covering all sixteen chapters of Mark, including the last twelve verses.

Key:

- s = singular reading (until all MSS have been collated, this is just an assumption; also, easy transcriptional errors could be made by more than one copyist, independently);
- c = corrected variant (variation of any kind corrected to the presumed archetype);
- x = uncorrected variant (‘variant’ here means that it is attested by MSS outside the family, but by no other family members; this could indicate mixture);
- y = family is divided, but the variant is also attested by MSS outside the family (this could be mixture on the part of whoever introduced the variant);
- / = family is divided, and the variant has no outside attestation (a splinter group);
- h = an obvious case of homoioteleuton (or –arcton) [I do not consider this to be a proper ‘variant’, but it is included below];
- i = sheer inattention (often repeating a syllable from one line to the next);
- = no departures from the presumed profile.

It will be observed that I attribute a smaller number of variants to the presumed exemplar than to the copy—I discount ‘c’, ‘s’, ‘h’ and ‘i’, ascribing them to the copyist; ‘c’ could have been done by someone else, but the result is correct. Of course, any of them might have been in the exemplar, and the exemplar might have had an error that the copyist corrected, so the numbers under ‘exemplar’ are only an approximation (but probably not far off). It is also true that a variant classed under ‘x’, ‘y’ or ‘/’ could be an independent mistake by the copyist, not in the exemplar. For all that, I consider that the general contour of the evidence given below is valid and relevant.

f³⁵ in Mark—raw data

MS	stats	total	exemplar	date	location ¹	content
18	5y, 1/, 7s, 2i	15	6	1364	Constantinople	eapr
35	5c	5	---	XI	Aegean	eapr
128	1y, 1/, 2s, 1h, 2i	7	2	XIII	Vatican	e
141	2x, 2y, 4/, 3c, 9s, 2h	22	8	XIII	Vatican	eapr
204	3y, 2/, 3s, 1i	9	5	XIII	Bologna	eap
510	1x, 1y, 9s, 3i	14	2	XII	Oxford-cc	e
547	10y, 1/, 4s	15	11	XI	Karakallu	eap
553	2x, 9y, 2/, 1c, 4s, 3i	21	13	XIII	Jerusalem	e

¹ I give the location where a MS was acquired, when this differs from where it is presently held, on the basis of available information.